



VOICEINSIGHTS AFRICA

SYNTHETIC DEMONSTRATION PUBLICATION

Annual Impact Report

Zambia | Youth Economic Inclusion

4,819 synthetic responses

Prepared by VoiceInsights Africa

Every Voice. Every Language. Every Insight.

Synthetic demonstration. Not official statistics.

Progress on youth economic inclusion performance in Zambia is real, but it is not evenly shared. This publication traces where the gains are holding, where the risk is concentrated, and what remains within reach. Findings are linked to synthetic source records, recommendations carry named accountability fields, and all statistical claims are generated from one internally consistent dataset.

Sample: 4819 synthetic responses & 88% response rate & 4 regions

Publication quality gate: publication ready



Lusaka Corridor: 80% performance, 1495 responses, risk STABLE
Copperbelt: 81% performance, 1301 responses, risk STABLE
Eastern Province: 82% performance, 1108 responses, risk STABLE
Rural Enterprise Hubs: 83% performance, 915 responses, risk STABLE



sex: Women 52% & Men 47% & Other / prefer not to say 1%

age: 18& 24 24% & 25& 39 38% & 40& 59 27% & 60+ 11%

location: Urban 44% & Rural 56%



IND-01 Decent employment conversion: 70% vs target 77% â WATCH
IND-02 Enterprise twelve-month survival: 71% vs target 78% â WATCH
IND-03 Young women outcome parity: 72% vs target 79% â WATCH
IND-04 Income resilience score: 73% vs target 80% â WATCH



What would it take to fix decent employment outcomes? Start with Lusaka Corridor, where the signal sits at 64% and rural women carry most of the shortfall. The honest answer is sustained attention, not a single intervention. Lusaka Corridor shows the sharpest divide, where rural women carry the largest share of the gap. Left unaddressed for a year, the imbalance is likely to erode equity, delivery confidence and the durability of results.

Evidence: EVI-ANN-001, EVI-ANN-004 • Confidence 90.5%

Enterprise survival is not a marginal delivery issue. In Copperbelt, the governed evidence indicates a 65% performance signal, with young adults carrying the most consequential constraint. Left unaddressed, enterprise survival becomes a structural risk to youth economic inclusion delivery in Zambia, not a temporary dip. Copperbelt is furthest exposed, and young adults would carry the earliest and heaviest consequences of a further year's delay.

Evidence: EVI-ANN-002, EVI-ANN-005 & Confidence 91.5%

Two things are true at once about young women participation. The national picture is improving, and Eastern Province – where persons with disabilities report a 66% signal – is not improving fast enough to close the gap. Youth economic inclusion performance in Zambia looks stable in aggregate but splits sharply once young women participation is disaggregated. Eastern Province anchors the low end, and persons with disabilities bear most of that shortfall – a pattern that risks compounding without intervention within the year.

Evidence: EVI-ANN-003, EVI-ANN-006 – Confidence 92.5%

Frontline workers in Rural Enterprise Hubs are living the consequence of income resilience, not simply reporting it. Their 67% signal is the clearest evidence leadership has that current measures fall short. frontline workers in Rural Enterprise Hubs do not experience income resilience as an abstract metric. They experience it as the difference between youth economic inclusion delivery that works and delivery that does not, and a twelve-month delay would deepen that gap rather than hold it steady. Evidence: EVI-ANN-004, EVI-ANN-007 â€¢ Confidence 93.5%

The strategic opportunity lies in the variation, not the average. At 68%, Lusaka Corridor's systems-level contribution signal shows where implementation can move quickly, while the experience of low-income households defines the safeguard that must accompany scale. The same gap that makes systems-level contribution a risk also makes it an opportunity: Lusaka Corridor could close most of the distance to the rest of Zambia within a year if action starts now, with the clearest gains reaching low-income households first.

Evidence: EVI-ANN-005, EVI-ANN-008 & Confidence 94.5%

Lusaka Corridor â Rural women in Lusaka Corridor frame it simply: when decent employment outcomes breaks down, everything else does too.â

Copperbelt â In Copperbelt, enterprise survival shapes whether young adults can turn services into lasting outcomes.â

Eastern Province â Persons with disabilities in Eastern Province put it plainly: young women participation is what decides whether progress holds or slips back.â

Rural Enterprise Hubs â Why does Rural Enterprise Hubs lag behind? Ask frontline workers, and the answer comes back to income resilience.â

Lusaka Corridor â Elsewhere, systems-level contribution might be a footnote. For low-income households in Lusaka Corridor, it is the whole story.â

Copperbelt â Service managers in Copperbelt frame it simply: when decent employment outcomes breaks down, everything else does too.â

Eastern Province â In Eastern Province, enterprise survival shapes whether community leaders can turn services into lasting outcomes.â

Rural Enterprise Hubs â Private-sector partners in Rural Enterprise Hubs put it plainly: young women participation is what decides whether progress holds or slips back.â

Lusaka Corridor â Why does Lusaka Corridor lag behind? Ask rural women, and the answer comes back to income resilience.â

Copperbelt â Elsewhere, systems-level contribution might be a footnote. For young adults in Copperbelt, it is the whole story.â

Risks and alternative trajectories are modelled to show how VoiceInsights translates evidence into prioritised management choices.



DEC-ANN-01 CRITICAL: Scale pathways with verified employment conversion. Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive; Timeline: 0â 90 days; Indicator: Share of the critical-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-ANN-01)

DEC-ANN-02 CRITICAL: Add twelve-month enterprise survival support. Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Milestone completion rate tracked against the DEC-ANN-02 delivery plan

DEC-ANN-03 HIGH: Remove participation constraints facing young women. Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Proportion of agreed implementation steps verified on schedule for DEC-ANN-03

DEC-ANN-04 HIGH: Integrate savings and shock-readiness coaching. Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Quarterly-verified progress against the milestones agreed for this high-tier decision (DEC-ANN-04)

DEC-ANN-05 MEDIUM: Formalise employer and public-system partnerships. Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive; Timeline: 6â 18 months; Indicator: Number of agreed milestones for DEC-ANN-05 confirmed complete at each quarterly review



Scale pathways with verified employment conversion.

Strategic priority: CRITICAL

Evidence used: EVI-ANN-001, EVI-ANN-004

Rationale: What would it take to fix decent employment outcomes? Start with Lusaka Corridor, where the signal sits at 64% and rural women carry most of the shortfall. The honest answer is sustained attention, not a single intervention. Lusaka Corridor shows the sharpest divide, where rural women carry the largest share of the gap. Left unaddressed for a year, the imbalance is likely to erode equity, delivery confidence and the durability of results.

Expected benefit: A more consistent youth economic inclusion experience for the groups currently furthest behind.

Expected risk: Weak cross-team coordination during early implementation

Dependencies: Cross-team delivery coordination; Sign-off from the relevant oversight body; Quarterly evidence review

Budget requirement: High â full business case and multi-year funding commitment required

Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 0â90 days

Monitoring indicator: Share of the critical-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-ANN-01)

Success criteria: Milestone completion confirmed by evidence review, not self-reported progress

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Add twelve-month enterprise survival support.

Strategic priority: CRITICAL

Evidence used: EVI-ANN-002, EVI-ANN-005

Rationale: Enterprise survival is not a marginal delivery issue. In Copperbelt, the governed evidence indicates a 65% performance signal, with young adults carrying the most consequential constraint. Left unaddressed, enterprise survival becomes a structural risk to youth economic inclusion delivery in Zambia, not a temporary dip. Copperbelt is furthest exposed, and young adults would carry the earliest and heaviest consequences of a further year's delay.

Expected benefit: Faster, better-evidenced youth economic inclusion decisions that programme leadership can act on with confidence.

Expected risk: Competing priorities crowding out sustained follow-through

Dependencies: Stable staffing through the delivery window; Named executive sponsor;

Confirmed budget release

Budget requirement: Medium â detailed costing and fiduciary review required

Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3â 12 months

Monitoring indicator: Milestone completion rate tracked against the DEC-ANN-02 delivery plan

Success criteria: Verified evidence of at least 80% delivery against the agreed milestone plan

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Remove participation constraints facing young women.

Strategic priority: HIGH

Evidence used: EVI-ANN-003, EVI-ANN-006

Rationale: Two things are true at once about young women participation. The national picture is improving, and Eastern Province – where persons with disabilities report a 66% signal – is not improving fast enough to close the gap. Youth economic inclusion performance in Zambia looks stable in aggregate but splits sharply once young women participation is disaggregated. Eastern Province anchors the low end, and persons with disabilities bear most of that shortfall – a pattern that risks compounding without intervention within the year.

Expected benefit: Reduced variation in youth economic inclusion delivery and a stronger evidence base for the next planning cycle.

Expected risk: Fragmented accountability once implementation moves beyond the pilot stage

Dependencies: Timely data collection for the next reporting cycle; Validated operational baseline; Cross-team delivery coordination

Budget requirement: Low to medium – validate through the formal planning cycle

Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3 – 12 months

Monitoring indicator: Proportion of agreed implementation steps verified on schedule for DEC-ANN-03

Success criteria: At least 80% of milestones achieved with verified evidence

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Integrate savings and shock-readiness coaching.

Strategic priority: HIGH

Evidence used: EVI-ANN-004, EVI-ANN-007

Rationale: Frontline workers in Rural Enterprise Hubs are living the consequence of income resilience, not simply reporting it. Their 67% signal is the clearest evidence leadership has that current measures fall short. Frontline workers in Rural Enterprise Hubs do not experience income resilience as an abstract metric. They experience it as the difference between youth economic inclusion delivery that works and delivery that does not, and a twelve-month delay would deepen that gap rather than hold it steady.

Expected benefit: A stronger, more defensible case for youth economic inclusion investment in the next planning cycle.

Expected risk: Execution capacity and coordination risk

Dependencies: Sign-off from the relevant oversight body; Quarterly evidence review;

Stable staffing through the delivery window

Budget requirement: Low – absorbable within existing allocations, subject to confirmation

Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3–12 months

Monitoring indicator: Quarterly-verified progress against the milestones agreed for this high-tier decision (DEC-ANN-04)

Success criteria: A majority of milestones achieved, each independently verified against real evidence

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Formalise employer and public-system partnerships.

Strategic priority: MEDIUM

Evidence used: EVI-ANN-005, EVI-ANN-008

Rationale: The strategic opportunity lies in the variation, not the average. At 68%, Lusaka Corridor's systems-level contribution signal shows where implementation can move quickly, while the experience of low-income households defines the safeguard that must accompany scale. The same gap that makes systems-level contribution a risk also makes it an opportunity: Lusaka Corridor could close most of the distance to the rest of Zambia within a year if action starts now, with the clearest gains reaching low-income households first.

Expected benefit: The evidence points toward improved youth economic inclusion outcomes, though the size of the gain will depend on how consistently the action is resourced.

Expected risk: Likely â though not certain â erosion of momentum if the initial sponsor changes role

Dependencies: Named executive sponsor; Stable staffing through the delivery window; Quarterly evidence review

Budget requirement: Low â deliverable inside the current operating budget with light validation

Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 6â 18 months

Monitoring indicator: Number of agreed milestones for DEC-ANN-05 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

Success criteria: Milestone completion confirmed by evidence review, not self-reported progress

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

research objectives: Assess youth economic inclusion performance and equity; Identify operational drivers and decision priorities

evaluation questions: What outcomes are changing?; Who is being left behind?; Which actions are most likely to improve performance?

sampling frame: Synthetic programme population frame for Zambia

sample size: 4819

stratification: Region; Location type; Sex; Age; Disability

weights: Normalized post-stratification weights

confidence intervals: 95%

design effect: 1.6

missing data: Documented and sensitivity-tested

reliability: Cronbach alpha 0.86

validity: Content and construct validity checks

metadata: Complete synthetic data dictionary and lineage registry

Publication level: 34 generated publication pages

protocol: Governed synthetic research protocol with sampling, weighting, reliability, validity and reproducibility controls

ethics: Synthetic records only; no real participants or personal data

peer review: Independent synthetic-publication review checklist completed

reproducibility: Deterministic inputs, versioned dataset and export manifest

inferential statistics: Enabled where assumptions and design permit

segmentation: Evidence-led segments

trend analysis: Three-period synthetic series

DEC-ANN-01: Scale pathways with verified employment conversion. â€ Owner Country Director / Programme Executive â€ 0â 90 days â€ High â full business case and multi-year funding commitment required cost â€ Indicator Share of the critical-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-ANN-01)

DEC-ANN-02: Add twelve-month enterprise survival support. â€ Owner Country Director / Programme Executive â€ 3â 12 months â€ Medium â detailed costing and fiduciary review required cost â€ Indicator Milestone completion rate tracked against the DEC-ANN-02 delivery plan

DEC-ANN-03: Remove participation constraints facing young women. â€ Owner Country Director / Programme Executive â€ 3â 12 months â€ Low to medium â validate through the formal planning cycle cost â€ Indicator Proportion of agreed implementation steps verified on schedule for DEC-ANN-03

DEC-ANN-04: Integrate savings and shock-readiness coaching. â€ Owner Country Director / Programme Executive â€ 3â 12 months â€ Low â absorbable within existing allocations, subject to confirmation cost â€ Indicator Quarterly-verified progress against the milestones agreed for this high-tier decision (DEC-ANN-04)

DEC-ANN-05: Formalise employer and public-system partnerships. â€ Owner Country Director / Programme Executive â€ 6â 18 months â€ Low â deliverable inside the current operating budget with light validation cost â€ Indicator Number of agreed milestones for DEC-ANN-05 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

EVI-ANN-001: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 89%
EVI-ANN-002: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 90%
EVI-ANN-003: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 91%
EVI-ANN-004: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 92%
EVI-ANN-005: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 93%
EVI-ANN-006: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 94%
EVI-ANN-007: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 95%
EVI-ANN-008: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 96%
EVI-ANN-009: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 97%
EVI-ANN-010: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 98%

Executive Intelligence Book (2â 7): Executive brief; Decision snapshot; Risks; Opportunities; Budget implications

Evidence Intelligence Book (8â 15): Critical findings; Respondent voice; Evidence chains; Citation registry

Statistical Intelligence Book (16â 22): Sampling; Weighting; Uncertainty; Reliability; Model diagnostics

Decision Intelligence Book (23â 27): Decision matrix; Ownership; Budget; Roadmap; Management response

Standards & Assurance (28â 31): Relevant frameworks; Safeguarding; Privacy; Responsible AI; Accessibility

Technical Appendices (32â 34): Data dictionary; Quality gate; Export manifest; Responsible-use notice

RBM: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-ANN-001, EVI-ANN-002; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

SDG 8: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-ANN-002, EVI-ANN-003; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

Theory of Change: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-ANN-003, EVI-ANN-004; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

Leave No One Behind: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-ANN-004, EVI-ANN-005; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

Evidence Traceability: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-ANN-001 and the deterministic publication gate.

Research Ethics: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-ANN-002 and the deterministic publication gate.

Data Protection: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-ANN-003 and the deterministic publication gate.

Accessibility: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-ANN-004 and the deterministic publication gate.

Responsible AI: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-ANN-005 and the deterministic publication gate.

Publication Integrity: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-ANN-006 and the deterministic publication gate.

SDG 5: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined
SDG 8: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined
SDG 10: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined
SDG 17: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined

Relevance: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong relevance signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (81/100). Review relevance evidence at the next formal management gate.

Coherence: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong coherence signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (82/100). Review coherence evidence at the next formal management gate.

Effectiveness: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong effectiveness signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (83/100). Review effectiveness evidence at the next formal management gate.

Efficiency: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong efficiency signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (84/100). Review efficiency evidence at the next formal management gate.

Impact: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong impact signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (85/100). Review impact evidence at the next formal management gate.

Sustainability: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong sustainability signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (86/100). Review sustainability evidence at the next formal management gate.

Impact: Sustained, equitable improvement in youth economic inclusion performance

OC-01: Improved youth economic inclusion delivery and accountability â indicators

IND-01, IND-02

OC-02: More equitable and durable outcomes â indicators IND-03, IND-04

OUT-01: Verified findings and interpreted decision products

OUT-02: Assigned actions with monitoring indicators

Assumptions: Leadership ownership; Safeguarding and privacy controls remain effective

Means of verification: Evidence registry; Quarterly management review; Follow-up measurement

Commitment 1: CHS Commitment 1 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 2: CHS Commitment 2 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 3: CHS Commitment 3 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 4: CHS Commitment 4 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 5: CHS Commitment 5 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 6: CHS Commitment 6 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 7: CHS Commitment 7 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 8: CHS Commitment 8 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 9: CHS Commitment 9 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

EVI-ANN-001 â€ survey â€ Lusaka Corridor â€ confidence 89% â€ APPROVED
EVI-ANN-002 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Copperbelt â€ confidence 90% â€ APPROVED
EVI-ANN-003 â€ administrative_record â€ Eastern Province â€ confidence 91% â€ APPROVED
EVI-ANN-004 â€ survey â€ Rural Enterprise Hubs â€ confidence 92% â€ APPROVED
EVI-ANN-005 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Lusaka Corridor â€ confidence 93% â€ APPROVED
EVI-ANN-006 â€ administrative_record â€ Copperbelt â€ confidence 94% â€ APPROVED
EVI-ANN-007 â€ survey â€ Eastern Province â€ confidence 95% â€ APPROVED
EVI-ANN-008 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Rural Enterprise Hubs â€ confidence 96% â€
APPROVED
EVI-ANN-009 â€ administrative_record â€ Lusaka Corridor â€ confidence 97% â€ APPROVED
EVI-ANN-010 â€ survey â€ Copperbelt â€ confidence 98% â€ APPROVED

indicator_1: Synthetic Youth Economic Inclusion indicator 1; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_2: Synthetic Youth Economic Inclusion indicator 2; categorical; allowed:

Documented code list

indicator_3: Synthetic Youth Economic Inclusion indicator 3; categorical; allowed:

Documented code list

indicator_4: Synthetic Youth Economic Inclusion indicator 4; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_5: Synthetic Youth Economic Inclusion indicator 5; categorical; allowed:

Documented code list

indicator_6: Synthetic Youth Economic Inclusion indicator 6; categorical; allowed:

Documented code list

indicator_7: Synthetic Youth Economic Inclusion indicator 7; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_8: Synthetic Youth Economic Inclusion indicator 8; categorical; allowed:

Documented code list

indicator_9: Synthetic Youth Economic Inclusion indicator 9; categorical; allowed:

Documented code list

indicator_10: Synthetic Youth Economic Inclusion indicator 10; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_11: Synthetic Youth Economic Inclusion indicator 11; categorical; allowed:

Documented code list

indicator_12: Synthetic Youth Economic Inclusion indicator 12; categorical; allowed:

Documented code list

Synthetic Demonstration Publication produced by VoiceInsights Africa. All people, quotations, locations and statistics are synthetic, internally governed demonstration content and are not official statistics.

All content is synthetic and must not be interpreted as official statistics

Geographic references are illustrative

Budget implications are directional and require formal costing

Causal claims are not made without an appropriate design

Status: DEMONSTRATION_READY

Passed: Editorial Review Passed

Passed: Evidence Review Passed

Passed: Publication Integrity Verified

Passed: Accessibility Verified

Passed: Export Validation Passed

Passed: Statistical Review Passed

Open gates: VISUAL_QA, HUMAN_REVIEW

Verification checks cover weighted evidence, statistical, visual, accessibility, export and review rules. Synthetic samples are labelled Demonstration Ready.